Khamang Phanit

Resource Identifier: CULT-FEST-007

English Translation: Communal River Fishing & Walnut Bark Festival

Category: Festival | Subcategory: Communal_Harvest

Village / Region: Hundung | Dialect: Hundung / Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Hundung & Ukhrul River Troupes (Documented in Arokianathan 1982, Ruivah 1993)

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: November / Autumn post-harvest season

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Autumn communal river expedition where river channels are treated with pulverized wild walnut root (Ngasung) to stun fish, accompanied by forest fellowship banquets.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Khamang phanitli tara kongli kazip, Hundung mibing saikora."
"Ngasung thingron aparali shailaga tara kongli horhaisa."
"Nga samphangda kaphung konglaoli ringkaphawui thotna mazaingasot."

English Translation & Meaning:

"At Khamang festival, the community gathers beside the mountain river channels."
"Harvesting and pounding wild walnut root (Ngasung) to stun river fish naturally."
"Sharing the bountiful catch in joyous forest fellowship banquets beneath the hills."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Gathering wild walnut root (Ngasung) and mountain herbal bark from high ridges.
2. Pounding the bark into fibrous pulp using wooden mallets on riverside rocks.
3. Releasing the sap into natural pools to temporarily stun river fish.
4. Communal harvesting of fish using conical cane nets and hands.
5. Riverside open-fire grilling and egalitarian distribution of fish among all clans.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

River Troupes, Youth Dormitories, Village Elders